

Course Outline – CRWR 116-3-3 Introduction to Creative Writing I

Section: 002
 Instructor: Corinna Chong
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Class time: T/Th 3:30 PM-4:50 PM
 Class location: A 145
 Office location: C 272A
 Office hours: W/F 2:00-3:20 PM (or by appt.)

Calendar description:

An introduction to composition in the genres of poetry, short fiction and the one-act play. Students experiment in each of these genres. By the end of the course, students will have a working knowledge of modern aesthetics, and a fairly objective appreciation of their own “voice” in the context of those aesthetics. (3,0,0)

Prerequisites: ABE ENGL 012¹ or English 12² or English 12 First Peoples² or AP English Language & Comp. 12² or Technical Professional Comm 12² **or** ABE ENGL 012 or English 12 or English 12 First Peoples or AP English Language & Comp. 12 or Technical Professional Comm 12 and Language Proficiency Index³ **or** mature student status and a score of 24/40 (level 4) or better on the LPI

¹ minimum grade of 60 required

² minimum score of 60 required

³ minimum score of 24 required

Instructor's description:

“You should write because you love the shape of stories and sentences and the creation of different words on a page. Writing comes from reading, and reading is the finest teacher of how to write.”

—Annie Proulx

Contrary to popular belief, most great writers are not born, but made. In this course, students will learn the fundamental principles and techniques for writing in the genres of fiction and poetry. The two most essential components to becoming a great writer are: 1. Reading and evaluating the work of others; and 2. Learning to revise and rewrite your own work. Throughout the course we will be reading numerous stories and poems that exemplify the strategies we are exploring. Much of the course will be devoted to reading and ‘workshopping’ the work of your peers. As such, you must be prepared to share your work and receive feedback. By the same token, it is vital that every student make it their objective to generate *constructive* and *respectful* feedback when evaluating peer work. You will use the feedback from your peers and Instructor to revise and improve your writing.

*Please note: A substantial amount of reading and writing is required outside of class time in order to keep up with the demands of this intensive course; expect a minimum of 1.5 hours of preparation time for every 80-minute class.

IMPORTANT DATES

First day of classes: Wed., Sept. 3, 2025
 Holidays (no classes): Tues., Sept. 30; Mon., Oct. 13; Mon., Nov. 10; Tues., Nov. 11

Drop/Add deadline: Fri., Sept. 12, 2025
 Last day of classes: Fri., Dec. 5, 2025
 Final assessment period: Dec. 9-18, 2025

LEARNING OUTCOMES

Students will learn to:

- Develop a process that involves generating, drafting, workshopping, revising and editing
- Use, recognize, and critique, both orally and in writing, elements of literary craft
- Read a variety of literary works and evaluate them from a writer's perspective
- Employ craft-based vocabulary while discussing and evaluating the work of others

- Offer and receive constructive and respectful feedback as a peer-editor and in workshop discussions
- Experiment with various formal and informal writing approaches

REQUIRED TEXTS AND MATERIALS

- Burroway, Janet. *Imaginative Writing: The Elements of Craft*. 5th ed., Pearson, 2024.
- Access to reliable internet, Moodle, and word processing software (ideally Microsoft Word)
- Access to a printer (pay-per-page printers are available in the OC library)
- A coil or bound notebook with lined pages (minimum 5.5" x 8.5" in size) for in-class assignments

COURSEWORK OVERVIEW (*detailed instructions for all assignments posted on Moodle)

Pieces	3 pieces (at least one poem and one piece of prose) generated from in-class exercises	Almost every class will involve a writing exercise to help students practice techniques and generate ideas. These exercises must be kept in a physical notebook. Students will select their best exercises to complete, polish, and submit at three points over the term. A scan or photo of the original exercise must be submitted along with each complete version, which must be typed into an MS Word doc. Of the three pieces, one must be a poem and one must be a story (the form of the third piece is up to you).	Due Sep. 16 Oct. 2 Oct. 16 (upload on Moodle <u>and</u> bring 3 printed copies to class)	15%
Submission	<u>Either</u> a piece of short fiction (800-1200-words) <u>or</u> a suite of 3 poems	Students will write either a piece of short fiction or a suite of three poems. (A suite is a collection of poems that are built around a common theme, form, image, or narrative.) Students will be put into groups (randomly selected in Week 7) to determine the deadline for their Submission. Each submission must be shared and workshopped with all members of the class. <u>Please note</u> : A 20% deduction will be taken from your grade if you do not attend the workshop for your Submission.	Due Group 1: Oct. 30 Group 2: Nov. 4 Group 3: Nov. 6 Group 4: Nov. 13 Group 5: Nov. 18 Group 6: Nov. 20 Group 7: Nov. 25 (upload to forum on Moodle)	20%
Workshop Notes	1-page responses to workshop questions for peer submissions	Students will read the stories of a selection of their peers and write point-form responses to a set of guiding workshop questions posted on Moodle. Groups (chosen in Week 7) will determine whose work you will be required to write notes for. Workshop notes must be submitted on Moodle <u>and</u> printed in hard copy and brought to class on the due date.	Due Nov. 6, 13, 18, 20, 25, 27, Dec. 2 (upload on Moodle <u>and</u> bring a printed copy)	15%
Formatting Quiz	Quiz on paragraph breaks, punctuation, and dialogue tags	Following the discussion of formatting conventions for fiction on Oct. 21, students will be tested on their understanding with a sample passage.	Oct. 23	5%

Process Reflection and Self-Evaluation	2-3 page personal reflection piece	Students will use a set of guiding questions to write a reflection on how their writing process has developed over the course of the term, and the skills and strategies they intend to work on moving forward.	Dec. 4 (upload on Moodle)	5%
Participation and Engagement	Attendance and verbal contributions	Students will be graded for their attendance as well as their participation in class exercises and discussions (especially during workshops). See attendance policy below for more details.	---	10%
Final Portfolio	Polished collection of exemplary work	Students will revise their work according to the feedback they received in workshops and resubmit them as an exemplary collection of their writing. Portfolios must include the <u>revised versions</u> of two Pieces (one poem and one story) and your Submission.	Dec. 15 (upload on Moodle before midnight)	30%

All written prose assignments should be formatted in MLA style. (See the ‘sample MLA story’ document posted on Moodle for more guidance).

SCHEDULE (subject to change according to the needs of the class)

IW = from *Imaginative Writing*

	DATE	READINGS FOR DISCUSSION	ASSIGNMENTS DUE	IN CLASS
WEEK 1	Sep. 4			- Course overview: expectations, assignments, etc. - Introduction to “poem of the week”
WEEK 2	Sep. 9	“Chapter 1: Invitation to the Writer” and “Chapter 2: Image” (<i>IW</i> 1-27)		In-class exercise: concrete, significant detail
	Sep. 11	“From Heaven and Earth in Jest” – Annie Dillard (<i>IW</i> 28-29)		In-class exercise: imagery
WEEK 3	Sep. 16		Piece #1 [*submit on Moodle <u>and</u> bring 3 printed copies to class]	- Workshop etiquette - Small group workshop
	Sep. 18	“Hairball” – Margaret Atwood (Moodle)		In-class exercises: clichés and metaphors
WEEK 4	Sep. 23	“Chapter 3: Voice” (<i>IW</i> 50-64) “Ode to American English” – Barbara Hamby (<i>IW</i> 86-87)		In-class exercise: voice
	Sep. 24	“Chapter 4: Character” (<i>IW</i> 93-108) “If You’ve Seen One Autistic Person, You’ve Seen One Autistic Person.” – Tom C. Hunley (<i>IW</i> 123)		In-class exercises: distinguishing features and character as dialogue

	DATE	READINGS FOR DISCUSSION	ASSIGNMENTS DUE	IN CLASS
WEEK 5	Sep. 30	National Day for Truth and Reconciliation – NO CLASSES		
	Oct. 2	▪ “Tandolfo the Great” – Richard Bausch (Moodle)	▪ Piece #2 [*submit on Moodle <u>and</u> bring 3 printed copies to class]	▪ Small-group workshop
WEEK 6	Oct. 7	▪ “Chapter 5: Setting” (<i>IW</i> 128-140) ▪ “Home” – Pauline Kaldas (<i>IW</i> 152)		▪ In-class exercises: setting as a camera and setting as mood
	Oct. 9	▪ “Chapter 6: Story” (<i>IW</i> 161-170)		▪ Group selections for Submission workshops
WEEK 7	Oct. 14	▪ “Incarnations of Burned Children” – David Foster Wallace (<i>IW</i> 174-176) ▪ “Columbine High School/Littleton, CO” – Albert Goldbarth (<i>IW</i> 190)		▪ In-class exercise: jumble story
	Oct. 16	▪ “Chapter 7: Development and Revision” (<i>IW</i> 196-212)	▪ Piece #3 [*submit on Moodle <u>and</u> bring 3 printed copies to class]	▪ Small-group workshop ▪ In-class exercise: revision
WEEK 8	Oct. 21	▪ “Chapter 9: Fiction” (<i>IW</i> 263-274, 297)		▪ Form in fiction ▪ In-class exercise: formatting conventions
	Oct. 23		▪ Formatting Quiz [in class]	▪ In-class exercise: scene and summary
WEEK 9	Oct. 28	▪ “Chapter 10: Poetry” (<i>IW</i> 299-319)		▪ In-class exercises: the poetic line and American sentences
	Oct. 30	▪ “Nude Interrogation” – Yusef Komunyakaa (<i>IW</i> 154) ▪ “The Grammar Lesson” – Steve Kowit (<i>IW</i> 322)	▪ Group 1 Submission [*submit on Moodle <u>before</u> class]	▪ In-class exercise: villanelles
WEEK 10	Nov. 4		▪ Group 2 Submission [*submit on Moodle <u>before</u> class]	▪ In-class exercises: found and aleatory poetry
	Nov. 6	▪ Group 1 Submissions	▪ Group 3 Submission [*submit on Moodle <u>before</u> class] ▪ Group 1 Workshop Notes [*submit on Moodle <u>and</u> bring a printed copy]	▪ Large group workshop
WEEK 11	Nov. 11	Remembrance Day – NO CLASSES		

	DATE	READINGS FOR DISCUSSION	ASSIGNMENTS DUE	IN CLASS
WEEK 11	Nov. 13	▪ Group 2 Submissions	▪ Group 4 Submission [*submit on Moodle <u>before</u> class] ▪ Group 2 Workshop Notes [*submit on Moodle <u>and</u> bring a printed copy]	▪ Large group workshop
WEEK 12	Nov. 18	▪ Group 3 Submissions	▪ Group 5 Submission [*submit on Moodle <u>before</u> class] ▪ Group 3 Workshop Notes [*submit on Moodle <u>and</u> bring a printed copy]	▪ Large group workshop
	Nov. 20	▪ Group 4 Submissions	▪ Group 6 Submission [*submit on Moodle <u>before</u> class] ▪ Group 4 Workshop Notes [*submit on Moodle <u>and</u> bring a printed copy]	▪ Large group workshop
WEEK 13	Nov. 25	▪ Group 5 Submissions	▪ Group 7 Submission [*submit on Moodle <u>before</u> class] ▪ Group 5 Workshop Notes [*submit on Moodle <u>and</u> bring a printed copy]	▪ Large group workshop
	Nov. 27	▪ Group 6 Submissions	▪ Group 6 Workshop Notes [*submit on Moodle <u>and</u> bring a printed copy]	▪ Large group workshop
WEEK 14	Dec. 2	▪ Group 7 Submissions	▪ Group 7 Workshop Notes [*submit on Moodle <u>and</u> bring a printed copy]	▪ Large group workshop
	Dec. 4	▪ “Examples [of Revision]” (<i>IW</i> 213-227)	▪ Process Reflection [*submit on Moodle]	▪ Work class: revisions and Portfolios

Final Portfolio due: Monday, Dec. 15 [*submit on Moodle before midnight]

ATTENDANCE

Because this course revolves around small-group and whole class discussions combined with exercises to practice the techniques we are learning, your participation in every lecture and workshop session is extremely important to your success in this course. Your presence and participation not only indicate your commitment to learning, but also demonstrate respect for your peers. As such, **excessive unexcused absences will result in deductions to your participation grade.**

In addition, attendance for your Submission workshop is mandatory. If you fail to attend the class during which your work is scheduled for workshop, you will receive a 20% deduction on your grade for the assignment.

That said, if you are feeling unwell or were in close contact with someone who was seriously ill with a contagious disease, you are encouraged to stay home and will not be penalized for doing so. Safety for everyone in the classroom is our number one priority! If you need to be away, be sure to make arrangements with me to ensure you keep up to speed with the course.

****Please note:** The Department of English requires students to confirm their registration in a course through attendance during the first five business days of the semester. Students who are unable to attend due to excusable absence (defined below) are required to contact the professor before or during that timeframe. Failure to do so will result in automatic de-registration from courses.

An excusable absence includes: personal illness; potential exposure to COVID-19; medical treatment or a visit to the doctor; death in the immediate family; job interview; legal proceedings; care for an ill or injured dependent or spouse; responsibilities as a parent or guardian; or sanctioned holy days.

LATE WORK POLICY

Assignments submitted electronically are due before class begins on the day they are due. Hard-copy assignments are due at the beginning of class the day they are due.

Submissions must be submitted on the due date, NO EXCEPTIONS. Your peers will have only one week to read and evaluate all the work for the next class's workshop, so it is imperative that everyone submits on time.

For all other assignments, late work will lose 2% per day after the due date, and may not receive comments. I will not accept assignments beyond one week past the due date, unless a student has made prior arrangements with me. If you must miss class, contact me as soon as possible. You will be responsible for submitting assignments due for the class you will miss **on or before the due date**. Students who are absent due to college-sanctioned activities must submit assignments **before the due date**.

****Note:** If you are handing in a hard-copy assignment outside of class time, please submit it to the main Arts office (E 103). The receptionist there will stamp your assignment with the date and ensure it gets to my mailbox. Please do not slip assignments under my door, as I cannot guarantee they will reach me!

GRADING

Standardized Grading System:

A+: 90-100%	B+: 76-79%	C+: 64-67%	D: 50-54%
A: 85-89%	B: 72-75%	C: 60-63%	F: 0-49%
A-: 80-84%	B-: 68-71%	C-: 55-59%	

The grading scheme and rubrics for this course are designed to encourage students to experiment, take creative risks, and treat writing as a multi-stage process. Remember that **writing is revision**, and to that end, the revised versions of your work are given greater weight than the initial drafts. In addition, being receptive to the feedback of your peers and instructor and implementing changes in response to their comments is an essential skill-set to develop if you want to improve your work, and will thus be a key factor in your final grade.

Detailed guidelines and grading rubrics that outline the criterion for each assignment will be posted on Moodle.

TECHNOLOGY

Cell phones: Please have your cell phones turned off or silenced and put away during class, unless we're doing an activity during which you're invited to use them. If you need to have your cell phone on in anticipation of an important or emergency phone call, please let me know at the beginning of class.

AI POLICY

While the Department of English recognizes the increasing prevalence and functionality of generative AI writing tools, our goal is to help you develop the critical thinking skills and creative capacity to effectively communicate your own ideas. In addition, the material generated by programs like ChatGPT may be erroneous, distorted, incomplete, or otherwise problematic. Using AI programs to generate and draft ideas is therefore not permitted, unless the instructor has developed an assignment or activity that

explicitly notes otherwise, in which case the AI-generated material should be cited like any other reference material.

Any assignment that uses material generated by an AI program without prior permission and proper citation may be penalized. These penalties can range from a finding of failure of scholarship, resulting in a lower grade, to additional discipline by the Dean for violating the College's Policy on Academic Integrity: https://www.okanagan.bc.ca/sites/default/files/2024-04/academic_integrity_policy.pdf

In this course, we may be experimenting in class with primitive generative AI tools like perchance.org and poem-generator.org through guided exercises that ensure you are using these tools to build and brainstorm your own ideas rather than adopting the software's content entirely. Guidelines for how to properly cite these tools will also be provided. Since developing your own unique, creative intention is a key learning outcome in this course, for any assignments completed outside of class time, the use of AI-generated material is strictly prohibited. The use of advanced generative AI tools like ChatGPT, Jasper AI, Copy.ai, Sudowrite, etc. for any exercises or assignments is not permitted.

ACCOMMODATIONS

Students who require accommodations due to disabilities should contact Disability Access Services as early in the semester as possible, then get in touch with me so we can ensure the accommodations are in place.

Disability Access Services is a department that offers a range of services to students with disabilities. The purpose of the service is to enable persons with disabilities to have equal access to educational opportunities at the post-secondary level. There is no charge for any of the services provided. Visit <https://www.okanagan.bc.ca/disability-access-services> for more information.

STUDENT SUCCESS CENTRE

Okanagan College has a Success Centre on the Kelowna campus (in the library in L 204 (across from circulation) that provides free assistance with coursework and academic skills. Help is available in English language, reading and writing, as well as math, science, and trades. Success Centre Coordinators are available to help you in person at all campuses and also online. Visit <https://www.okanagan.bc.ca/success-centres> to book an appointment.

COUNSELLING SERVICES

Okanagan College has professionally trained counsellors on staff full-time to help students with any academic and/or personal struggles they may be facing. Counselling sessions are completely free for students and can be booked online. All communication between the student and counsellor is strictly confidential and will not be disclosed to anyone outside the Counselling Services department. You can visit <https://www.okanagan.bc.ca/counselling-services> for more information, and/or to book an appointment with a counsellor.

INDIGENOUS SERVICES

Okanagan College provides culturally relevant support services for Indigenous learners, including visiting elders, cultural and academic workshops, peer mentors, information about Indigenous awards, scholarships, and bursaries, and computer access. Visit <https://www.okanagan.bc.ca/indigenous-services> for more information to learn about the Indigenous Services team and/or book an appointment with an Indigenous Mentor.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY POLICY

Students are expected to adhere to Okanagan College's Academic Integrity Policy, which outlines violations of plagiarism/cheating that will not be tolerated in this course or any other academic setting.

Please be aware that it is much easier than you might think for instructors to spot plagiarized material. The penalties for plagiarism could be as severe as a failing grade in a course or even dismissal from the academic institution. In short, it is not worth the risk.

Note also that academic integrity violations can take a number of forms. While the following list of examples characterizes the most common instances of integrity violations, the list is not intended to be exhaustive:

- a. Plagiarism includes but is not limited to, when a student:
 - i. submits or presents work of another person, in whole or part, as that of the student's own work;
 - ii. fails to provide adequate attribution (author/creator must be acknowledged in the text, in footnotes, in endnotes, or in another accepted form of academic citation) to an author or creator whose work is incorporated into the student's work, including another person's words, ideas, or entire works;
 - iii. paraphrases material from a source without sufficient acknowledgement;
 - iv. does not ensure the work is the student's own after the student has sought assistance from a tutor or other scholastic aids.
- b. Cheating in assignments, projects, examinations or other forms of evaluation, may include, but is not limited to:
 - i. using or attempting to use another person's answers/work;
 - ii. purposely exposing or providing answers to another student(s), or failing to take reasonable measures to protect answers from use by another student(s);
 - iii. unless permitted by the Instructor, a student submitting identical or virtually identical assignments/materials for evaluation, in the case of students who study/work together, or otherwise, as the student's own work;
 - iv. sharing information or answers when doing take-home or take-away assignments, tests or examinations except where the Instructor has authorized collaborative work;
 - v. unless permitted by the Instructor, a student using artificial intelligence tools for coursework submitted for evaluation.
- c. Multiple submissions: submitting the same, or substantially the same, work more than once (whether the earlier submission was at the College or another institution) unless prior approval has been obtained from the Instructor to whom the material is to be submitted.
- d. Aiding or attempting to aid others in any academic integrity violation.
- e. Academic fraud:
 - i. falsifying or submitting false records or information, orally or in writing;
 - ii. failing to provide relevant information when requested;
 - iii. falsifying or submitting false documents, transcripts or other academic credentials.
- f. Any behaviour that undermines the College's ability to evaluate a student's academic achievement, or any behaviour that a student knew, or reasonably ought to have known, could gain him/her or others unearned academic advantage or benefit, is a violation of academic integrity.